

MEHRASA AMIRI BESHILI

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science • CHIVE Lab, Louisiana State University

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction, proactive conversational agents, AI-augmented sensemaking, serious games for accessibility.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Louisiana State University

Advisor: Prof. Mahmood Jasim

Jan 2025 – Present

Baton Rouge, LA

GPA: 4.0/4.0

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering

Isfahan University of Technology

2018 – 2023

Isfahan, Iran

PUBLICATIONS

Conference Papers

Mehrassa Amiri Besheli and Mahmood Jasim. “SPARC: Exploring Interaction, Sensemaking, and Engagement in AI-Augmented News Reading.” In *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Conversational User Interfaces (CUI '26)*, Bremen, Germany, 2026. [DOI]

Mehrassa Amiri Besheli and Mahmood Jasim. “Combining AI and Crowdsourcing to Identify Misinformation in Online News.” In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*, Yokohama, Japan, 2025. [DOI]

Under Review

[Title withheld for anonymous review]. Under submission to the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2027).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant

CHIVE Lab, Louisiana State University (Advisor: Prof. Mahmood Jasim)

Jan 2025 – Present

Baton Rouge, LA

I study how proactive conversational agents can support people’s sensemaking in complex analytical tasks, such as reading news and exploring information. I design and build interactive systems that pair conversational AI with visual cues, and evaluate them through formative studies and large-scale user studies.

Graduate Research Assistant, LSU TPSID Project

U.S. Department of Education grant (\$2.2M), Louisiana State University

Dec 2025 – Present

Baton Rouge, LA

Designing and developing a serious game that teaches emergency-response skills to adults with intellectual disabilities.

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Sep 2022 – May 2023

Isfahan University of Technology (Advisor: Prof. Safayani)

Isfahan, Iran

Studied and implemented weight-based pruning methods (layer-wise and global) to compress neural networks with minimal accuracy loss.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2nd Place, College Track, Nexus Louisiana Technology Cup (pitched APNE)	2025
Ranked in the top 1% of the Iranian National University Entrance Exam	2018

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Artificial Intelligence (Graduate)	Spring 2023
<i>Isfahan University of Technology (Prof. Mansoori)</i>	
Teaching Assistant, Advanced Programming; Compiler Design	Spring 2021
<i>Isfahan University of Technology (Prof. Mansoori)</i>	

SERVICE

Reviewer

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)	2027
ACM Conference on Conversational User Interfaces (CUI)	2026

Outreach

Judge, High School Summer Research (HSSR) Poster Competition, College of Engineering, LSU 2025

Leadership

President, Panjereh Club (book and philosophy club), Isfahan University of Technology 2019 – 2022

SKILLS

Research Methods	User studies, surveys, semi-structured interviews, qualitative coding, statistical analysis
Programming	Python, C/C++, JavaScript, React
Tools	PyTorch, scikit-learn, LLM APIs, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Languages	Persian (native), English (fluent)